whistle went and we'd lost 1–0, the last the old Wembley heard from England supporters was them booing us off. To lose the last game at Wembley—and to lose it to Germany—was one of the worst experiences I've ever had in soccer. I walked down the touchline towards the dressing rooms just a few yards ahead of Kevin Keegan. I could hear the abuse he was getting from fans near enough to the running track to make themselves heard. It wasn't personal, what was being shouted at him. Instead, they were telling Kevin what they thought of him as England manager. Second-hand stuff, lifted from the back pages, saying he didn't have a clue—which was really harsh and insulting towards a man who'd achieved so much during thirty-odd years in soccer. It hadn't taken long for everybody to forget that Kevin had been first choice, by a mile, to take over when Glenn Hoddle resigned.

I was surprised at what happened when we got down into the dressing rooms but, because I'd been listening to what those supporters had been saying, I had an idea why Kevin made up his mind so quickly about what he should do. I could understand him, after taking that abuse, wondering if it was worth it. Even so, what actually happened in the hour after that Germany game came as a huge shock. We hadn't even started changing. Most of us were just getting something to drink. Kevin walked in and stood in the middle of the room. Then he told us he was leaving:

'I have to be honest with you. And honest with myself. I've gone as far as I can with this. I'm calling it a day. You've got good times ahead of you. You're very good players.'

I know it was an instant decision because even his assistant Arthur Cox, who knew Kevin better than any of us, didn't know what was coming. He was the first to speak up:

'No, Kevin. Don't do this.'

I remember my reaction:

'Kevin, we want you as England manager.'

It was all falling apart and now we were losing Kevin Keegan. Personally, I didn't feel let down. I wouldn't have said a bad word about one of the best managers I've ever worked with. Kevin felt he knew what he had to do and he'd made up his mind completely. He told us he was going to step down. Then he told Adam Crozier, the FA Chief Executive. And then he told the press. What a way to finish things off: all the great things that had happened at Wembley, and all the good times we'd had with Kevin, ended with the rain